

wallpaper made of jute, sisal, raffia and host of other natural fibres.

If the walls flaunt natural fibres and exquisite elegance, the furnishings must complement them. “The first choice for many is “the most expensive fabrics that money can buy, sourced from global markets,” says Rachna. It is one way of maintaining exclusivity; buying what many others can’t afford. The interiors shopping list in premium Indian homes is like Sarojini Naidu’s epic poem *The Bazaars of Hyderabad*. Ralph Lauren, Houles, Jim Thompson, Arezzo, Dedar Milano, Andrew Martin and Fabric Art are all available for use in Indian interiors.

T **HERE IS ENOUGH** wealth in these premium coffers to source anything from around the world. The proud owners are well travelled and often demand what they have experienced in other parts of the world.

106 | Monica Kamal Studios is inundated with requests from those who know what luxury means to them or those who depend on her to interpret their wants. Kamal says in many cases, especially among those new to luxury interiors, the cost of the fabric determines the choice. The fairs in Milan offer a range of minimalist furniture. But the furnishings, the branded cushions, throws from her studio and her expertise elevate it above the ordinary. “Increasingly, buyers of luxury homes are spending on the most expensive materials and products to make a style statement,” she says. Pastels have replaced the earthy rust tones of yesteryears. She shops globally to keep her range modern and appealing to the newest entrants.

However, Devika Mehra also had a young finance person from Chennai who was returning after many years in New York and opted for hand painted silk wallpaper. “She could afford it and knew its value.” Many others don’t and opt for lookalikes. One buyer in Central Delhi, who also had a farmhouse up for decoration, did not have time. Having seen their work and given a brief, he was quite happy to let the designers



1. SHAILJA VOHORA-
designed interiors.
For her, it starts
with listening
to clients

2. KARMA LAKELANDS,
a golf resort
for sustainable
lifestyles

3. MONIKA KAMAL
says buyers are
spending on the
most expensive
materials

do their job and leave him free to make his millions.

This is where client aspirations and designer style must sync. Sanjay Sharma of Interiors with Art Ltd uses AI and tech to create luxury interiors. But when designers start dictating the look and feel of the space, owners lose comfort. He recalled one imposing classical baroque design in a dining room with a high ceiling by a designer that so intimidated the owners that they ended up spending more time in less imposing verandas. Clearly, style has to be tempered with elegance and comfort for the users.

